

FIT5125
IT Research and Innovation Methods
Semester 1 2026

IT Research and Innovation Methods · Assignment 2

This assignment uses the Monash University standard grading schema see: <https://publicpolicydms.monash.edu/Monash/documents/1935755>

N - Fail	P - Pass	C - Credit	D – Distinction	HD - High Distinction
Lack of satisfactory demonstration of fundamental knowledge, skills and expected attributes.	Demonstration of fundamental knowledge, skills and attributes at a satisfactory level.	Demonstration of fundamental knowledge, skills and attributes at a proficient level, showing fluency in concepts.	Demonstration of extended knowledge, skills and attributes at a superior level, showing fluency and emerging originality and integration of concepts.	Demonstration of extended knowledge, skills and attributes at an exceptional level, showing fluency, originality and integration of concepts.
0-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%

The following criteria will be used to determine the score for each element of the assignment:

- Content and completeness
- Clarity and relevance of content
- Level of critical analysis
- Logical structure and organization of ideas
- Use of references (where appropriate)
- Format, grammar and spelling

Task A: "Telling a Data Story" (12 marks)

- Formulation and expression of the research question
- Selection and use of descriptive metrics
- Design and use of visualisation
- Quality of narrative description

Task B: "Working with Hypotheses" (12 marks)

- Clear formulation and expression of the research hypothesis and null hypothesis
- Independent, dependent and confounding variables correctly identified

- Clear formulation, justification and feasibility of data collection
- Clear formulation and justification of proposed statistical analysis
- Clear description of the study limitations
- Clear formulation and justification of alternative narrative

Task C: "Understanding the Design Context" (21 marks)

Task C1 (Understanding the Design Context)

- Thoroughly analysed the bank of user quotes, showing clear understanding of emotional issues in online collaboration.
- Applied latent coding (prioritised over semantic coding) to uncover deeper meanings, assumptions, tensions, and socio-linguistic dynamics embedded in the quotes.
- Developed a well-structured affinity diagram that groups ideas logically, showing clear synthesis of patterns, user needs, frustrations, and opportunities.
- Identified coherent, higher-level themes that accurately reflect the interpretive insights gained through coding.
- Produced two or more design problem statements that are specific, actionable, grounded in the themes, and clearly articulate the core emotional issues users face in the Zoom context.

Task C2 (Design Ideation)

- Brainstormed design ideas that meaningfully respond to the identified problem statements and reflect thoughtful engagement with user needs, and proposed two significantly different design solutions, each clearly described and visually extended on the Miro board.
- Explained how each design addresses the challenges, needs, and opportunities surfaced in the user quotes and affinity diagram.
- Provided a clear, well-reasoned design rationale for each solution
- Demonstrated critical thinking by showing how the design decisions logically follow from the research insights rather than being generic feature suggestions.